Speak English: 3-Month Fluency Planner

From Basics to Fluency — Your Week-by-Week Roadmap

Golden rule: Consistency over intensity. 30 minutes daily beats 3 hours once a week.

MONTH 1: FOUNDATION

Goal: Build daily habits, master high-frequency vocabulary, and get comfortable speaking from Day One.

Week 1 — Start Speaking Immediately

- Daily: 15 min reading aloud (newspaper/short story), with expression
- Daily: Talk to yourself in the mirror for 5 min (describe your day, your surroundings)
- Start a 3-sentence English journal every night
- Learn 10 new high-frequency words/day, always in a phrase (e.g. "make a decision," not just "decision")
- Weekend: Watch one episode of a beginner-friendly show with subtitles (e.g. *Home Alone*, *Mrs. Doubtfire*)

Week 2 — Build Listening & Rhythm

- Daily: Listen to a BBC Learning English or VOA Learning English video (3–5 min)
- Daily: Repeat sentences aloud, mimicking stress and intonation
- Continue journaling + vocabulary (10 words/day)
- Read the same short paragraph aloud twice: once normal, once at double speed
- Weekend: Record yourself speaking for 1 minute; listen back and note 2 things to improve

Week 3 — Find a Speaking Partner

- Sign up for Tandem, HelloTalk, or Speaky

- Have your first 10-minute exchange conversation
- Daily: Mirror practice + read-aloud (now with unfamiliar articles)
- Learn 10 filler phrases for when you get stuck (e.g. “Let me think…”, “What I mean is…”)
- Weekend: Watch *English Vinglish* or *Slumdog Millionaire* with subtitles

Week 4 — Review & Reinforce

- Review all vocabulary from Weeks 1–3 (spaced repetition)
- Daily: 20-min spoken practice (mirror + partner combined)
- Self-check: Can you describe your day in English for 2 minutes without stopping?
- Weekend: Journal reflection — what’s easier now vs. Week 1?

Month 1 Milestone: You can hold a basic 5-minute conversation and read aloud smoothly.

MONTH 2: BUILDING FLUENCY

Goal: Increase speaking volume, reduce mental translation, and get comfortable with imperfection.

Week 5 — Think in English

- Daily: Practice forming thoughts directly in English (no mental translation)
- Daily: 15-min conversation with your language partner
- Join one English-speaking WhatsApp group or online community
- Watch *The Namesake* or *Life of Pi* — note 5 new phrases

Week 6 — Expand Real Conversation

- Daily speaking goal: minimum 15 minutes spoken English
- Speak English at every real-life opportunity (shops, colleagues, friends)
- Continue journal — now aim for 5+ sentences/day
- Read a news article aloud 3 times; notice it gets smoother each time

Week 7 — Tackle Getting Stuck

- Practice the “stuck” strategies: simplify, slow down, use fillers
- Prepare go-to phrases for common topics: work, family, hobbies
- Daily: 15–20 min speaking practice + 1 podcast episode
- Weekend: Record a 2-minute talk on a prepared topic; review fluency, not perfection

Week 8 — Immersion Push

- Watch one full movie in English with subtitles (from the list below)
- Sing along to 2–3 English songs this week
- Daily conversation practice with partner (aim for natural back-and-forth)
- Self-check: Are you translating less and thinking in English more?

Month 2 Milestone: You can speak for 5+ minutes on a familiar topic without long pauses.

MONTH 3: FLUENCY & CONFIDENCE

Goal: Sound natural, handle unexpected topics, and speak with confidence under pressure.

Week 9 — Natural Speech Patterns

- Daily: Shadow a podcast (listen + repeat immediately after each sentence)
- Focus on rhythm, stress, and intonation when reading aloud
- Have 2 unscripted conversations this week (no prepared topic)
- Watch *Bend It Like Beckham* — note slang and casual expressions

Week 10 — Real-World Pressure

- Speak English in a slightly uncomfortable setting (new group, call, meeting)
- Daily: 20-min conversation practice
- Practice recovering gracefully from mistakes using filler phrases
- Journal: write about a mistake you made and how you handled it

Week 11 — Vocabulary Depth

- Review all vocabulary collected across 10 weeks

- Learn idioms and collocations from your journal/conversations
- Daily: mix of reading aloud, journaling, and speaking practice
- Weekend: Watch *The Pursuit of Happyness* — summarize the plot aloud in English

Week 12 — Fluency Test & Celebration

- Record a 5-minute talk on any topic — compare it to your Week 1 recording
- Have an extended (20+ min) real conversation with your partner
- Reflect in your journal: how far have you come?
- Set your next 3-month goal (advanced vocabulary, accent work, professional English, etc.)

Month 3 Milestone: You can hold a natural, confident conversation on most everyday topics.

Daily Habit Checklist (Repeat Every Day)

- Read aloud (10–15 min)
- Speak — mirror, partner, or real life (15–20 min)
- Journal 3+ sentences
- Learn/review 5–10 words in context

Resources Toolkit

Apps for Speaking Partners: Tandem · HelloTalk · Speaky

YouTube Channels:

- BBC Learning English (@bbclearningenglish) — short, everyday phrases
- VOA Learning English (@VOALearningEnglish) — slow, clear news-based lessons
- Speak English with Tiffani — grammar + confidence building

Movies (clear, relatable English): Slumdog Millionaire · The Jungle Book (2016) · Life of Pi · English Vinglish · Bend It Like Beckham · The Namesake · Home Alone · Mrs. Doubtfire · The Pursuit of Happyness

TV for Natural Conversation: Friends · The Office

> “The secret of getting ahead is getting started.” — Mark Twain

Be patient. Be persistent. Be proud.